



OPERATING ENVIRONMENT REFERENCE

Ed Barlow's PC Setup

If I document it, it will become accurate.

Ed Barlow Web Cloud Studio · 2026

Purpose

Document my development environment and tooling.

```
bash Prototyper/bin/build_documentation.sh # → Master Documentat
bash Prototyper/bin/build_pdf.sh docs/whitepapers/ed_barlow_setup.md # → ./ed_barlow_setup
```

Environment

Property	Value
Platform	Ubuntu 22.04 (Jammy) on WSL2, hosted under Windows
Shell	bash
GPU	NVIDIA RTX 4060 Laptop (8 GB); <code>nvidia-smi</code> works inside WSL
<code>\$MYPROJECTS</code>	Root directory for all git repositories (<code>/mnt/c/Users/barlo/projects</code>)

The working interface is bash inside WSL. Windows-side applications (Docker Desktop, Ollama, Anaconda) are reached from bash through WSL interop, never through a PowerShell console.

Installed Tooling

System CLI (apt)

Tool	Use
<code>tree</code>	Directory structure at a glance.
<code>shellcheck</code>	Lint <code>bin/*.sh</code> before committing.

Other command-line utilities are listed under **Utilities** below.

Language toolchains

Tool	Use
<code>uv</code>	Virtual environments and dependency management in WSL.
<code>ruff</code>	Python linting and formatting.
<code>pytest</code>	Test runner; <code>bin/test.sh</code> wraps it and must pass before commit.
<code>playwright</code>	Headless Chromium — drives the white-paper → PDF render.
<code>node</code> (via <code>nvm</code>)	Node 20 toolchain.

Anaconda lives on the **Windows** side; `uv` is the WSL standard. They do not overlap.

SQLite and the CLI access pattern

SQLite is the default persistent store, reached directly with the `sqlite3` client:

```
sqlite3 data/app.db           # interactive shell
sqlite3 data/app.db '.tables' # list tables
sqlite3 data/app.db '.schema users' # inspect a table
sqlite3 -header -column data/app.db 'SELECT * FROM users LIMIT 20;' # readable query output
sqlite3 data/app.db '.mode csv' '.import in.csv users' # bulk load
```

`-header -column` is the standard pair for legible ad-hoc queries. Application code reaches the same database only through its typed access class — the `sqlite3` client is for inspection, not for production writes.

Docker

Docker Desktop runs on Windows; the `docker` CLI is exposed to bash through **WSL integration**. When integration is off, `docker` resolves to the Windows binary but the daemon is unreachable.

```
# 1. Launch Docker Desktop and enable WSL integration (GUI, one time):
#   Settings (gear) → Resources → WSL Integration →
#   enable "default WSL distro" and toggle Ubuntu → Apply & Restart.
# 2. Verify from bash:
docker version
docker run --rm hello-world

# Update Docker Desktop from bash (winget runs from bash, not PowerShell):
winget.exe upgrade --id Docker.DockerDesktop
# Or: launch the app and use Settings → Software Updates → Check for updates.
"/mnt/c/Program Files/Docker/Docker/Docker Desktop.exe" &
```

Local models (Ollama + GPU)

Ollama is installed on Windows and called from WSL through the `ollama` alias. The RTX 4060 (8 GB) runs 7-8B quantized models comfortably.

```
export OLLAMA_HOST=127.0.0.1:11434 # in .bashrc
ollama serve & # or start the Windows tray app
ollama pull llama3.1:8b
curl localhost:11434/api/tags # confirm the API is up
```

Platform tooling

Tool	Location	Purpose
<code>run_llm_agent.sh</code>	<code>Prototyper/bin/run_llm_agent.sh</code>	The LLM-call primitive. Every script that invokes a model goes through it — never <code>claude</code> directly. Wraps the CLI agent (Claude by default; Codex via <code>USE_CODEX=1 / LLM_PROVIDER=codex</code>). Prompt on stdin; final text to stdout; events and token usage to <code>\$RAW_LOG / \$LOG_FILE</code> . <code>--stream</code> runs the streaming pipeline. The single seam through which all batched AI calls pass.
<code>build_documentation.sh</code>	<code>Prototyper/bin/build_documentation.sh</code>	The only documentation command ever called. Builds project documentation, exposed via <code>docs/index.html</code> , and cascades to the white-paper renderer when <code>docs/whitepapers/*.md</code> exist. All sub-builders are convenience methods, not invoked directly.
<code>build_pdf.sh</code>	<code>Prototyper/bin/build_pdf.sh <file></code>	Convert a <code>.md</code> (branded white paper) or <code>.html</code> file to a PDF in the current directory . Extension-driven: <code>.md</code> → HTML → PDF, <code>.html</code> → PDF. Renders via headless Chromium.
newwin	<code>Developer-Tooling/newwin</code>	Opens a 3-pane IDE tab in Windows Terminal for a project. Always opens in a named window <code>BASE</code> — creates it on first call, adds a tab thereafter. Each project is locked to one of 10 colour schemes. Requires <code>\$MYPROJECTS</code> ; state in <code>newwin.json</code> .
log_entry	<code>Developer-Tooling/log_entry.py</code>	Platform LEARNINGS log helper; backs the <code>slearn / stodo /...</code> shell functions.

Shell Setup

`bash` configured in `~/.bashrc` (sourced by `~/.profile` for login shells). Backups are kept dated: `~/.bashrc.YYYYMMDD`.

Conventions

- `set -o vi` — vi editing mode on the command line; `EDITOR / VISUAL` set to `vi` to match.
- Shared history across all terminals**

```
shopt -s histappend
HISTSIZE=100000
HISTFILESIZE=200000
```

```
HISTTIMEFORMAT='%F %T '
PROMPT_COMMAND="history -a; history -c; history -r${PROMPT_COMMAND:+; $PROMPT_COMMAND}"
```

- **PATH** — adds `$MYPROJECTS/Developer-Tooling`, `~/bin`, and `~/.local/bin`. `nvm` loads Node.

Main aliases and functions

Alias / function	Action
<code>pro</code>	<code>cd \$MYPROJECTS</code>
<code>myidea</code> / <code>myquery</code> / <code>mytrack</code>	<code>book.py idea</code> / <code>query</code> / <code>track</code>
<code>mntg</code>	Mount <code>G:</code> at <code>/mnt/g</code>
<code>ollama</code>	Windows Ollama binary via WSL interop
<code>slearn</code> <code>stodo</code> <code>sbook</code> <code>sidea</code> <code>scomplete</code>	Append an entry to the platform <code>LEARNINGS.md</code> via <code>log_entry.py</code>
<code>fd</code> / <code>bat</code>	Aliased to Ubuntu's <code>fdfind</code> / <code>batcat</code>

Utilities

Command-line utilities on the box. Description in black, **install command in blue**, usage in monospace.

fzf — fuzzy finder.

`sudo apt-get install -y fzf`

Usage: `Ctrl-R` fuzzy history · `Ctrl-T` file picker · `Alt-C` fuzzy cd.

Configured — key bindings sourced in .bashrc.

fd — fast, ergonomic `find` replacement.

`sudo apt-get install -y fd-find`

Usage: `fd PATTERN` · `fd -e py` by extension · `fd -H` include hidden.

Configured — aliased `fd` → `fdfind` in .bashrc.

bat — `cat` with syntax highlighting, line numbers, and a git gutter.

`sudo apt-get install -y bat`

Usage: `bat FILE` · `bat -n` line numbers · `bat -p` plain.

Configured — aliased `bat` → `batcat` in .bashrc.

ncdu — interactive disk-usage browser; find what is eating space.

`sudo apt-get install -y ncdu`

Usage: `ncdu DIR`; arrows navigate, `d` delete, `q` quit.

entr — run a command when files change.

`sudo apt-get install -y entr`

Usage: `ls *.py | entr -r ./bin/test.sh` (`-r` reload, `-c` clear).

direnv — per-directory environment / auto venv activation on `cd`.

`sudo apt-get install -y direnv`

Usage: write `.envrc`, then `direnv allow`.
 Further work — add `eval "$(direnv hook bash)"` to `.bashrc`.

lazygit — terminal git UI: staging, branches, history.

`sudo snap install lazygit`

Usage: `lazygit` in a repo; `space` stage, `c` commit, `P` push.

Not installed.

bttop — rich resource monitor (CPU / GPU / memory).

`sudo snap install bttop`

Usage: `bttop`; `m` menu, `q` quit.

Not installed.

yq — `jq` for YAML / TOML.

`uv tool install yq`

Usage: `yq '.key' file.yaml`.

Not installed.

shfmt — shell formatter; pairs with `shellcheck` for `bin/*.sh`.

`go install mvdan.cc/sh/v3/cmd/shfmt@latest`

Usage: `shfmt -w bin/script.sh`.

Not installed (Go).

To enumerate what is already installed when refreshing this list:

```
apt-mark showmanual | sort      # explicitly installed apt packages
snap list                      # snap packages
uv tool list                   # python CLI tools
npm -g ls --depth=0            # node globals
ls "/mnt/c/Users/barlo/AppData/Local/Programs" # Windows per-user installs
```

Agent Behaviour

`~/.claude/CLAUDE.md` and `~/.codex/AGENTS.md` hold the agent contract. Summary:

Git policy

- **Commit immediately** after completing any task that has no errors.
- Commit messages are descriptive — **no "OpenAi", "Claude", "Anthropic", or "AI" mentions.**
- **Do not push.** Local commits only.
- **No co-authored-by lines.**

Model invocation

- **Avoid paid API-token usage** — no metered API keys in scripts or tools.
- **Route model calls through the `run_llm_agent.sh` primitive** as much as possible. It runs via the CLI subscription and honours the `USE_CODEX` environment variable.

Directory scope

- Projects live under `$MYPROJECTS`; files therein are read/write. No access outside that tree without explicit permission.

Response voice (BRANDING_EDSVOICE)

How LLMs respond in interactive sessions — `RulesEngine/BRANDING_EDSVOICE.md`:

- **Lead with the answer or decision**, then the why, then the key tradeoff. No preamble.
- Terse and professional; no hedging; own the recommendation.
- **Formal English in written artifacts** — no contractions ("you are", "do not").
- Use the word **specification**, not "spec" (except in code itself).
- End every response with the terminator: `----- REQUEST COMPLETED -----`.
- Before the terminator, include `NEXT STEPS` (actions / blocked work) and `QUESTIONS` (decisions only Ed can make). Carry unresolved items forward.

Project Standards

These apply per project.

Standard	Rule
Conformed Project	A project brought to platform standards — carries a <code>CLAUDE_RULES.md</code> block in <code>AGENTS.md</code> and a <code>METADATA.md</code> as authoritative identity.
Python environment	Anaconda on the Windows side; <code>uv</code> for virtual environments and dependencies in WSL.
Lint / format	<code>ruff</code> for linting and formatting.
Testing	<code>pytest</code> ; <code>bin/test.sh</code> runs the suite and must pass before commit.
Scripts	Executables live in <code>bin/</code> (generally bash); a <code># CommandCenter Operation</code> header registers them with the platform.
Shared libs	<code>common.sh</code> / <code>common.py</code> provide env loading, logging, SIGTERM, heartbeat. Source / import rather than re-implement.
Line endings	Linux (no <code>\r</code>); <code>chmod +x bin/*.sh</code> .

A **Conformed Project** carries a generated `CLAUDE_RULES.md` block in its `AGENTS.md` (markers `CLAUDE_RULES_START` ... `CLAUDE_RULES_END`), produced from `RulesEngine/BUSINESS_RULES.md` and injected by Prototyper tooling — replaceable, do not hand-edit it. Its `METADATA.md` is authoritative for `name`, `display_name`, `short_description`, `git_repo`, never inferred from directory names. Conformance is mechanised by `bin/ProjectInitialize.sh` (assess → mechanical fixes → agent conformance → validate); it is idempotent.

Standard Directory Layout

Code directories carry no `.py` or `.sh` programs in their root.

```
<project>/
  bin/      code execution (start.sh, test.sh, ...)
  src/      source
  docs/     documentation
  data/     data
```

inbound/
Prompts/

inbound raw data
prompts

Documentation and Voices

`build_documentation.sh` is the single documentation entry point; the **documentation agent** in Prototyper writes project documentation from existing docs, code, or specifications.

Voice is tooling: each **output** carries its own register, independent of the others. The target is either **me** or a **program/output you write** — never a third-party recipient. All inherit the brand from

`RulesEngine/BRANDING_MAIN.md`.

Output	Voice file
Chat to Ed	<code>RulesEngine/BRANDING_EDSVOICE.md</code>
Documentation site	<code>RulesEngine/BRANDING_DOCUMENTATION.md</code>
White papers	<code>RulesEngine/BRANDING_WHITEPAPERS.md</code>
Website / portfolio	<code>RulesEngine/BRANDING_WEBSITE.md</code>
Social / blog posts	<code>RulesEngine/BRANDING_POSTS.md</code>

Not yet defined: proposals (client-facing) — to be authored.

Skills

Global skills live in `~/.claude/skills/`; project skills in each project's `.claude/skills/`.

Skill	Scope	Purpose
<code>make_plan</code>	Global	Produce an implementation plan before coding.
<code>live-iterate</code>	Prototyper	In-session editing of a specification and its code — the BOTH behaviour without a cold run.
<code>update-rules</code>	Prototyper	Edit the rules engine and regenerate <code>CLAUDE_RULES.md</code> .

The former global `iterate` skill is retired; use `live-iterate`.